BA INTERNATIONAL STUDIES
THESIS SEMINARS GUIDELINES FOR SUPERVISORS AND SECOND READERS
2024-2025, semester 1

The following information is intended for supervisors/examiners of students in BA International Studies who are producing their bachelor's thesis. It explicates the specific nature of this degree programme, and the concomitant characteristics of its bachelor's thesis, derived from the Course and Examinations Regulation (CER). Next, it describes the procedure for establishing a grade for a thesis, including the tasks of the supervisor and the second reader, respectively.

1. Aims of BA International Studies

The Bachelor of Arts in International Studies provides students with the tools to investigate globalization and its regional effects from a humanities perspective. They study these effects through the prism of four disciplinary perspectives: culture, history, politics and economics, coupled with in-depth knowledge of one of eight world regions. The humanities perspective is ensured by placing an understanding of the historic and cultural context centrally in the programme, and linking this directly to the political and economic conditions. Students learn to apply the acquired knowledge of the four disciplinary approaches in the analysis of a geographical area of their choice with the aid of a language native to that area.

2. Objectives of the bachelor thesis in International Studies

Based on the knowledge and skills acquired, students will be able to:

a) work with research techniques that are current in the discipline(s) covered;
b) comprehend sophisticated academic debates;
c) report on their studies and research in good written English;
d) work and write under time-pressure, and deal with deadlines.

The general academic skills covered by these aims are the following:

a) collecting and selecting specialized literature using traditional and electronic methods and techniques;
b) analysing and evaluating this in terms of quality and reliability;
c) formulating a well-defined research question based on this;
d) setting up, under supervision, a study of limited size, taking into consideration the traditional and electronic methods and techniques relevant for the discipline;
e) formulating a reasoned conclusion on the basis of this;
f) explaining research findings in writing in a clear and well-argued way.

3. Supervision

Students working on their bachelor's thesis are supervised by faculty members both in a classroom context (the thesis seminar), and individually. The seminar concentrates on research skills and writing processes; for guidance in matters of substance and content, a more individual approach needs to be provided. The thesis seminar leader is therefore also responsible for the individual supervision and finally acts as the first reader.

Attending the seminar is mandatory; no thesis can be submitted that has not been written in the context of a thesis seminar. Students should inform their supervisor, if possible in advance, when they are unable to attend a session. If a student misses more than two class meetings or more than one individual meeting, this may have consequences which ultimately could result in the student being unenrolled for the seminar. Before taking steps, the supervisor discusses this matter with the thesis seminar coordinator to explore the possible measures and to ensure equity in treatment.

Each seminar will be devoted to one of the geographical areas covered by International Studies. Thesis seminar leaders should set a theme for the seminars that lends itself to an approach from multiple disciplinary perspectives. Within the theme, thesis seminar leaders provide guidance for students to decide on their specific research topic. Although the theme should be broad enough to allow students to choose a topic of their own preference, the topic of their thesis should be clearly connected to the theme of the seminar.

The thesis should focus on a regional issue and analyse it within a global context. Alternatively, the thesis may tackle a regional issue from the perspective of two disciplinary approaches, including at least (one of) the stated disciplinary perspective(s) of the seminar in the analysis of the chosen topic of their thesis. The student and the supervisor need to agree on the choice of one of the two options.

Before their enrolment for the seminar, students will be asked to indicate the research topic they would like to cover, and the disciplinary perspective(s) they intend to use, as well as how these will connect to the thesis seminar theme and approach. This indication will be used to match students with a seminar/supervisor. Students should connect their topic to the theme of the seminar in order for the supervisor to be able to supervise and assess the chosen topic. The thesis supervisor can, in discussion with the student, ensure that there is a match between the topic and approach of the student's research plan and the theme and disciplinary approach of the thesis seminar itself within the above guidelines. In exceptional cases, when the seminar leader is unable to supervise and assess the chosen topic, a switch to another seminar within the same area can be made in consultation with the thesis seminar coordinator.

It is important to realise that students of International Studies have a limited training in each disciplinary perspective, consisting of two to four courses in their entire programme, and have, besides training in various individual aspects of conducting academic research, had specific practise with no more than two sizeable research projects in Research Methods and/or the Thematic Seminar. As a result, care should be taken both in what can be expected from the student regarding their knowledge of specific disciplinary theories and methodologies, as well as what they can be allowed to use as methodology, particularly those of a more advanced nature.

The exact set-up of the seminars may vary due to the nature of the area, the number of seminars offered in each area, and the teaching approach the seminar's leader will take. There should be 4-6 group meetings for general instruction, discussion and students' peer feedback and the minimum of 4 individual meetings of approx. half an hour each per student (see Appendix 1 for a suggested meeting schedule). Although there are some guidelines provided for you by the programme, there is a certain amount of freedom in the form you as the seminar's leader can teach the central elements of writing a thesis, including writing a research plan, formulating a research question, writing a good literature review, etc. For instance, in seminars with more students it may be impractical to have presentations by all students of their research set up, so forms of online peer review can be used instead.

Given the past experience, it may be useful to pay attention to the following elements within the seminars. Introduce the theme in the first seminar and ask each student to explain what they want to research and how it connects to the theme. It can be useful to provide a limited amount of literature on the theme and possible methodologies to the students. Discuss what a good thesis proposal, research question, literature review, and (draft) thesis should contain before submission, and then discuss common problems after providing feedback. The MS Teams channels for 'Thesis supervisors of BA International Studies', that you have access to, contain various helpful documents, weblinks, PPTs, very good sample thesis (graded 8 or more) and excellent theses shortlisted for the Golden Stork thesis award, which can be shared with students.

A classroom is reserved for the timeslot allocated to your seminar, allowing you to adjust the suggested overall schedule of group vs. individual meetings according to your own preferences. For the timetable, classroom bookings and the course description of your seminar in the prospectus, please contact onderwijsvoorbereidingDH@hum.leidenuniv.nl. Booking a meeting room for other moments later can also be done through the administration: osz-admin-thehague@hum.leidenuniv.nl. You can later check all bookings in MyTimetable at https://rooster.universiteitleiden.nl/schedule. Supervisors can invite the students to come to their office in Leiden or The Hague, but should consider that many of the International Studies students do not travel for free. The preferred place for meetings is therefore The Hague. The schedule for the individual meetings in Appendix 1 is a minimal indication only; it should, however, also be made clear from the outset that there is a limit to the amount of supervision students can obtain.

In the context of the seminar, the student is to submit three assignments before submitting the final version of the thesis (see Appendix 2):

- Thesis proposal: research question and plan (within four weeks);
- Literature review (within seven weeks);
- Thesis draft (week 49 in sem. 1 and week 18 in sem. 2).

The assignments are a prerequisite for submitting the thesis. It should be made clear to the students that they provide the only opportunity to receive actual feedback on their work. The more effort they put in, the more they will benefit from it. All three assignments must be discussed with the students individually as soon as possible after they have been submitted, preferably in the following week, so that the students do not have to proceed with their work without the guidance.

The deadline for all assignments is always Friday, at 23.59 h., in the appropriate week. As these deadlines are coordinated with the deadlines in other courses during the semester, they should not be moved. Students of International Studies have been trained to understand that meeting a deadline is very much part of the assignment itself. Moreover, since the spring semester is in practice longer than the fall semester, it is important that in the longer spring semester, too, due dates are strictly maintained, so that students are not advantaged or disadvantaged because of the semester in which they have chosen to take their thesis seminar.

Note that due dates cannot be extended unless serious personal circumstances justify the delay. In such a case the supervisor can give the student a deadline extension of max. 5 working days. When it concerns the submission of the final thesis version, the supervisor needs to inform the assigned second reader, the thesis seminar coordinator and the study

advisors as well (bais.stuco@hum.leidenuniv.nl). Students who need a longer extension due to personal circumstances must be referred to their study advisor before submitting a request to the Board of Examiners.

Students without an extension who fail to hand in their thesis on or before the original deadline, but still within 5 working days of that deadline, will receive a grade and feedback on their thesis. This will be considered a first submission of the thesis; however, the grade may be lowered as a consequence of the longer process of completion. This is to the lecturer's discretion.

Students who fail to hand in their thesis on or before the original deadline, and also fail to hand in their thesis within 5 working days of that deadline, may still hand in a first version of their thesis within 10 working days, counting from the original deadline. However, this first version will count as a resubmitted thesis with a consequential lowering of the grade, and, in case of a failing grade, there will be no option of handing in a revised version.

The supervisor is not responsible for the final version of the thesis – the student must decide themselves if the final version is ready to be submitted and graded. If a student has attended the group seminars and individual meetings as required, and submitted all the required assignments, they have the right to submit their thesis. As their supervisor, you may still advise them against it if you believe the likely quality of the final version would be too low, and point out that, once they have submitted it and failed, they will need to choose another topic or research question next semester.

You may also refuse to accept and grade an incomplete thesis or one that obviously fails to meet the knockout criteria. In case of doubt, please contact the Board of Examiners (bais-examinationscommittee@hum.leidenuniv.nl). Also, if a student hasn't met all the requirements of the course, such as the attendance and the assignments, you may exclude them from your seminar and not accept the final thesis. To avoid unclear situations, it is advisable to inform them about it per email once they failed to submit an assignment or show up for a meeting.

4. Assessment, Grading and Administration Process (First and Second Readers)

Submission of the following assignments is prerequisite for submitting the thesis:

- Thesis proposal (approx. 1,200-1,500 words);
- Literature review (approx. 2,500 words);
- Thesis draft (minimum format to be decided by the supervisor, but including at least a full chapter next to the literature review).

The final grade for the thesis seminar is determined by the thesis grade. Assessment of participation in the thesis seminar is included in the final thesis assessment form under 'Learning skills (process)'. To successfully complete this course, the grade for the thesis needs to be a 6.0 or higher. The supervisor is responsible for feedback on all assignments, as well as for the assessment of the final thesis. The second reader only assesses the final thesis.

4.1. Thesis submission and plagiarism check

To submit their thesis, the student needs to:

1. Upload the file via a Brightspace assignment, **or** email it directly to the supervisor – depending on what your preference is;
2. Email the file to bathesis@hum.leidenuniv.nl on the same day, **or** include the latter address cc: in the email sent to the supervisor. (The date of this message will provide a confirmation of the thesis grade date for the administration.)

Once the thesis has been evaluated with a passing grade, the student needs to:

3. Upload the file in the university's Thesis Repository (tab 'Submit'): https://studenttheses.universiteitleiden.nl/

The thesis grade can only be registered in uSis after the thesis has been uploaded in the Repository.

Currently, the thesis assessment system contains a built-in Turnitin module which checks the uploaded theses for plagiarism. This has consequences for the use of Turnitin plagiarism check for the assignments in Brightspace. For instance, if a thesis draft submitted in Brightspace has been stored in Turnitin for future similarly checks, the Turnitin report in the thesis assessment system will indicate up to a 100% similarity score for the final version of the same thesis, and thus hinder the assessment process. You can avoid that by making sure that, if you enable the Turnitin plagiarism check in the assignment's settings, you select the option **'Do not store the submitted papers'** under More options > Submission settings. (For Brightspace support, you can contact ecole@hum.leidenuniv.nl.) An alternative is not to enable similarity reports for Brightspace assignments at all. A significant disadvantage of that option, however, is that you won't be able to assess your students' referencing and paraphrasing skills throughout the semester until they have submitted their final thesis version. The plagiarism check of the final thesis should only be done in the thesis assessment system.

At the moment, there is no fully reliable software available to check theses for Artificial Intelligence-assisted or AI-generated passages. However, students need to be made aware that both plagiarism and the use of AI to generate thesis text are considered fraud. That may also include other forms of AI-assistance. As indicated in our faculty's Vice-deans' memo of June 12, 2023, '[w]hen a student uses AI (to a large extent) for a writing assignment, and the examiner cannot distinguish between the parts written by the student or the AI, this impedes the judgment of knowledge and skills, which is fraud'. Please make your students aware that we expect original work. Any suspicion of plagiarism or AI-generated text is to be reported to the Board of Examiners of International Studies immediately. (Please include the the thesis and the Turnitin-report, if available.) Please discontinue grading the thesis involved, inform the second reader about the delay, and inform the student to await further notice from the Board. **Never submit a grade to the administration before the Board has notified you of their conclusion.**

4.2. Assessment and grading

The first and the second readers have four weeks to read and grade the thesis in the online thesis assessment system. To smoothen the process of assessment it is recommended that the supervisor uploads the thesis and sets up assessment in the thesis assessment system, including the information about the second reader, as soon as the thesis has been submitted. The second reader should automatically receive a message that they can start with the evaluation, and they can access the thesis file as well as the Turnitin report through the assessment system. However, it is also advisable to mail the thesis directly to the second reader as soon as you have received it since the automatic mailing occasionally fails.

The supervisor and the second reader each fill out an assessment form independently from each other before agreeing on the final grade and filling out a third, combined form. The supervisor is ultimately responsible for ensuring the assessment has been completed in time. If for some reason this is not possible, for instance, due to an illness, please make sure to inform the student in question as well as the thesis seminar coordinator, and contact the Programme Board and the Educational Director of your Institute before the deadline of four weeks expires.

NOTE: When setting up the assessment form, do not save it before uploading the thesis as the system will not accept the upload later. If you do, you may need to ask the support to delete the incomplete assessment form and set up a new one.
NOTE: Essential steps in filling out the assessment form are generating a similarity report and confirming the thesis is free of plagiarism, without which further assessment will be blocked.
NOTE: In case of problems or specific questions, please contact the helpdesk at scriptieform@hum.leidenuniv.nl, or your student administration.

Both the first and the second reader independently check on the fulfilment of the following minimal standards (‘knockout criteria’). The thesis:

1. Contains a clear academic research question;
2. Is situated within a relevant academic debate;
3a. Places the analysis of the regionally defined topic in a global perspective, or
3b. Analyses the topic from at least two different disciplinary perspectives;
4. Accounts for the chosen research method(s) and materials;
5. Is based on the evaluation of a sufficiently large body of independently collected scholarly literature and/or sources (ca. 10-20, depending on whether books and/or articles are discussed);
6. Contains a well-structured and consistent argument;
7. Is written in correct English;
8. Produces a scholarly argument and analysis;
9. Counts 10.000 words (± 10%), excluding bibliography and notes.

The referencing style is Chicago. It is up to the supervisor to determine whether that should be the ‘notes and bibliography’ or the ‘author-date’ version.

If the first or the second reader finds that the thesis does not fulfil **all** the above minimum standards, they decide together whether a fail grade should be awarded. Please note

that a failing grade for one criterion cannot be compensated with sufficient grades for the others. If the above criteria are met, the supervisor and the second reader independently assess and grade the thesis based on the following criteria in the thesis assessment form:

- Knowledge and insight (contents, relation to the field).
- Application knowledge and insight (methodology).
- Reaching conclusions (interpretation, argumentation, conclusion).
- Communication (writing skills, structure).
- Learning skills (process).

When grading theses, please keep in mind that the multidisciplinary education of International Studies students implies that they are trained to understand their region in a wider comparative/global context. As a consequence, they are not as profoundly trained in a particular discipline (e.g. history, politics, economics, sociolinguistics or cultural studies) or region as students who follow a more specialized programme. They should, however, be better equipped than such students in treating regional issues from a global perspective and the combination of various disciplinary approaches.

For second readers it is important to note that the supervisors at International Studies have to deal with a wide range of topics and disciplinary approaches. As a result, the materials used and approaches taken cannot always be scrutinised at the level of an expert. This means that the theses will have to be assessed on the basis of the execution of the approach taken and material used as agreed between the supervisor and the student, and not on what is missing.

4.3. Establishing the final grade and administration

After both readers have filled out their assessment forms independently, their conclusions need to be compared and discussed. If they agree on the grade, they electronically sign and submit a third, joint digital assessment form. If the first and the second reader cannot reach consensus on the grade, the thesis and the opinions of both readers need to be sent to the Board of Examiners. The Board will then arrange for a third reader to decide on the final outcome.

The thesis grade will be expressed as a whole number or a number with one decimal place between 1.0 and 10.0, including both limits. The grade must not be expressed as a number between 5.0 and 6.0. **If the grade awarded is a 6.0, the thesis will be sent to the Board of Examiners with the request for a third reader** to either confirm the assessment of the first two readers that the thesis is passable, or decide that the thesis does not fulfil the requirements and should be awarded a failing grade. In the latter case, the third reader will motivate this decision in writing.

NOTE: Students have no direct access to the thesis assessment system, but they automatically receive a copy of the assessment at their umail address once the final (combined) assessment has been signed by both thesis readers electronically in the system. The same message is sent to both readers as well as to the administration, who then complete the process in uSis. Should you as the supervisor receive no such message, please check if the form has been signed properly in the system and, if necessary, contact the helpdesk

4.4. Failing and resubmitting the thesis

A student who scores an insufficient grade for the thesis (5.0 or lower) is allowed to resubmit a revised version of their thesis. The deadline for resubmission of the thesis is 10 working days after receiving the grade for the thesis and the feedback. In case of thesis resubmission, the grade will be lowered as a consequence of the longer process of completion. This lowering should not result in failing an otherwise passable thesis. The procedure is as follows:

- In case of a failing grade it is essential that the final assessment form contains clear feedback on the basis of which the student can revise their thesis for resubmission. Once the form has been completed and signed, a message with the grade and the feedback will be sent automatically to both readers, the administration and the student. It is advisable that the supervisor contacts the student to make sure the message and the feedback included in the assessment form has indeed been received on the basis of which they can revise and resubmit their theses. The supervisor and the student should preferably discuss the feedback a.s.a.p. in an individual meeting.
- The deadline for the student to resubmit the thesis is 10 working days after receiving the grade and the feedback. The revised thesis is to be assessed by the same two readers as the first failed version.
- When establishing the final grade for the resubmitted thesis by both readers, an appropriate deduction of the mark will be made for the process.
- Students who receive a failing grade for their resubmitted thesis have to take another seminar in the next semester. Please note that theses can only be submitted in the context of a seminar; students cannot submit or resubmit a previously written thesis in another seminar.

Appointment of supervisors and second readers

Supervisors (first readers), second and third readers are appointed by the Board of Examiners after consulting the Directors of Education of the Faculty's academic institutes. Supervisors are responsible for providing suggestions for appropriate second readers from their institute using the list of available staff which will be provided by the institute. The thesis seminar coordinator will approach them about it halfway through the semester, by when all the thesis topics should have been determined. Under no circumstances should students themselves approach faculty members for this task. The second readers' names should preferably not be communicated to the students either as those may still change even close to the submission deadline.

Thesis Repository and sensitive thesis content

Please remind your students about the obligation to upload the final version of their thesis (as a .pdf file) to the Student Repository as part of the graduation procedure as soon as they have received a sufficient thesis grade.

Leiden University's Student Repository is an online archive that makes information about bachelor's and master's theses easily searchable. Following the university's policy, bachelor's theses are not made publicly available (while master's theses may). In the case of a

bachelor's thesis, the following information will be publicly available and visible to search machines:

- the author,
- the year,
- the title,
- the subtitle,
- the faculty and the study programme, and,
- the supervisor.

Some brief remarks or a short abstract can be included. Please make your students aware of the public availability of the information when they are writing on a politically, culturally or socially sensitive topic, and discuss with them a safe formulation of the publicly visible data. In exceptional cases it may be decided not to store the thesis in the general repository. Please contact scriptie@library.leidenuniv.nl (cc: BAIS thesis seminar coordinator at g.j.rowicka@hum.leidenuniv.nl) about the options.

APPENDIX 1: SUGGESTED SCHEDULE

Fall semester of 2024 (students' due dates in italic; the due dates for supervisors and second readers in bold italic):

Week	**Date**	**Activities**
37	9 – 13 Sept.	class meeting
38	16 – 20 Sept.	class meeting or individual meetings
39	23 – 27 Sept	individual meetings
40	deadline 4 Oct. 23.59 (3 & 4 Oct. Relief of Leiden, holiday)	*submission of research question and plan*
41	7 – 11 Oct.	individual meetings
42	14 – 18 Oct.	class meeting
43	deadline 25 Oct, 23.59	*submission of literature review*
44	28 Oct. – 1 Nov.	midterms
45	4 – 8 Nov.	individual meetings
46	11 – 15 Nov.	class meeting or individual meetings
47	18 – 22 Nov.	class meeting or individual meetings
48	25 – 29 Nov.	
49	deadline 6 Dec., 23.59	*submission of draft*
50	9 – 13 Dec.	individual meetings
51	16 – 20 Dec.	exam period starts; individual meetings
52	23 Dec. – 2 Jan. 2025	no classes; Xmas holidays
1	3 Jan.	
2	deadline 10 Jan., 23.59	*submission of definitive version.*
3	13 – 17 Jan.	
4	20 – 24 Jan.	
5	27 – 31 Jan.	
6	**3 – 7 Febr. 2025**	***submission of grades to the administration***

Spring semester of 2025:

Week	**Date**	**Activities**
6	3 – 7 Feb.	class meeting
7	10 – 14 Feb.	class meeting or individual meetings
8	17 – 21 Feb.	individual meetings
9	deadline 28 Feb., 23:59	*submission of research question and plan*
10	3 – 7 March	individual meetings
11	10 – 14 March	class meeting
12	deadline 21 March, 23:59	*submission of literature review*
13	24 – 28 March	midterms
14	31 March – 4 April	individual meetings
15	7 – 11 April	class meeting or individual meetings
16	14 – 17 April (18 April Good Friday, 21 April Easter Mon.)	class meeting or individual meetings
17	21 – 25 April	
18	deadline 2 May, 23:59	*submission of draft*
19	6 – 9 May (5 May Liberation Day)	individual meetings
20	12 – 16 May	individual meetings
21	19 – 23 May	exam period starts; individual meetings
22	26 – 28 May (29 & 30 May Ascension)	
23	deadline 6 June, 23:59	*submission of definitive version*
24	10 – 13 June (9 June Pentecost)	
25	16 – 20 June	
26	23 – 27 June	
27	**30 June – 4 July**	***submission of grades to the administration***

APPENDIX 2. THESIS PROPOSAL AND LITERATURE REVIEW

Thesis proposal: research question and plan (1,200-1,500 words)

Students have to write their thesis in the context of the theme and disciplinary approach(es) of their seminar. They have to be able to explain to their fellow students in the seminar how their research contributes to the more general question that is central to the seminar.

The thesis proposal should include the following parts:

1. Tentative title,
2. Three to five keywords that quickly identify the research field and focus,
3. Research question,
4. Relevance of the research,
5. Methodology (how will the research question be answered?),
6. Preliminary outline of chapters,
7. Timeline/planning, and,
8. Bibliography (key sources).

For a suggested format, see the 'BA International Studies Proposal form'. All thesis proposals should if possible be presented, or at least discussed, in class.

Literature review (approx.2,500 words)

Once students have decided on a topic which the thesis seminar leader is willing to supervise, and formulated a concrete research question and plan, they will be looking for relevant academic studies to formulate a concise state of the art. The aim of this assignment is to come to a survey of the debate on the topic of the thesis and/or the theoretical approaches taken in the relevant academic studies on the subject, i.e. well-documented and published through widely respected channels.

In some subdisciplines of humanities it is common to include such information as a separate 'Literature review' chapter, while in others as a part of the introduction or as parts of several chapters, e.g. 'Historical background' and 'Theoretical framework'. Supervisors may choose what is most appropriate and, for instance, ask students to turn in a draft of an extensive introduction or a chapter on the historical background within the same word limit, instead of a literature review chapter.

The literature review is explicitly not meant as a separate writing assignment, but should help students in building towards their final thesis. Students should realise that the substance of the argument made in the first two assignments basically leads to the framework of the introduction and the first introductory chapter of their thesis. They are strongly recommended to anticipate the writing of those by presenting the thesis proposal and the literature review as drafts that in a later stage will be revised, if necessary, and integrated into the draft and the final version of the thesis.

The number of publications to be discussed in the literature review assignment should be somewhere between ten and twenty, depending on whether books and/or articles will be discussed. Online sources may be used, depending on the quality of the website and always in

combination with academic literature. The word limit should be approx. 2,500 words, depending, among others, on the way the literature is processed in the rest of the thesis.

The thesis proposal, the literature review and the thesis draft are to be submitted via assignments in the seminar's Brightspace module. While it can be insightful for the supervisor and instructive for the students to have their submissions checked in Turnitin for plagiarism, it is essential to make sure those texts are **not** stored for future similarity checks (see 4.1 above.)

APPENDIX 3. INDIVIDUAL MEETINGS: WHAT CAN STUDENTS EXPECT?

During the semester each student participating in a thesis seminar will have at least four individual meetings of approximately half an hour each with his or her supervisor. The aim of these meetings is not only to discuss the topic of the student's research, but also to discuss written feedback and give oral feedback on the submitted assignments: the research proposal, the literature review, and the draft. The supervisor will need some time to properly read and comment on the assignment. However, all three assignments need to be discussed with the students individually as soon as possible after they have been submitted, preferably in the following week, so that the students do not have to proceed with their work without the supervisor's guidance.

Students should realize that the amount of in-depth feedback they receive usually depends on the supervisor's specialism and the focus of the seminar, as well as on the quality of their own work. Less developed work results automatically in more superficial feedback. The primary focus in the feedback lies on how the student deals with the collected information. The feedback may vary from one assignment to another:

- *Research proposal*: the supervisor will concentrate on the components mentioned in the proposal form: a provisional title; the research question (and sub-questions); relevance; methodology; a provisional outline of chapters; a timeline/planning; and key sources. The feasibility of the intended research will also be discussed .
- *Literature review*: the supervisor will focus on the relevance of the consulted studies in connection to the research proposal, either as the state of the art or as a representation of a theoretical framework.
- *Draft*: the more complete a draft is, the more feedback supervisors can give, e.g., on the argumentation, structure, etc. It is advisable for students to hand in a complete first version of the thesis, which can then be improved upon based on the feedback. A draft version should, however, include at least one complete chapter next to the literature review, as well as a framework of the other chapters to allow the supervisor to get a better insight in the student's approach and furnish adequate comments and suggestions.

Depending on the priorities and preferences of the supervisor, each assignment can also be checked for plagiarism, referencing style, and language use, as well as the incorporation of earlier feedback.

Students are not only expected to submit their assignments in time, and be present at the meetings, but also to be well-prepared for the individual meetings as part of their own time management. They are encouraged to reflect in advance on the matters they intend to discuss with their supervisor, the questions they have, and the difficulties they experience. Students are strongly recommended to take notes during the individual meetings to enable them to incorporate the feedback in the next assignments to be submitted.

APPENDIX 4: USEFUL INFORMATION

Contact

Board of Examiners	bais-examinationscommittee@hum.leidenuniv.nl
Administration, grades	osz-admin-thehague@hum.leidenuniv.nl
Planning, timetables, rooms	onderwijsvoorbereidingDH@hum.leidenuniv.nl
Study advisers	bais.stuco@hum.leidenuniv.nl
Thesis seminar coordinator	g.j.rowicka@hum.leidenuniv.nl

Useful links for supervisors

Helpdesk: Brightspace ecole@hum.leidenuniv.nl
Brightspace manuals https://www.staff.universiteitleiden.nl/vr/humanities/fgw-learning/education-at-humanities/brightspace-at-fh?cf=humanities&cd=fgw-board-office
Assessment form info
https://www.staff.universiteitleiden.nl/education/tests-and-theses/tests-and-theses/tests-and-theses/humanities?cf=humanities#bachelor-international-studies
Assessment system login https://www.scriptiebeoordeling-hum.leidenuniv.nl/login/
Helpdesk: thesis assessment form scriptieform@hum.leidenuniv.nl (071 5271641)
International Studies webpage https://www.universiteitleiden.nl/en/internationalstudies
MS Teams group 'Thesis supervisors of BA International Studies'
Course and Examination Regulations BA International Studies
https://www.organisatiegids.universiteitleiden.nl/en/regulations/humanities/oer/international-studies-ba

Useful links for students

Student repository:
https://studenttheses.universiteitleiden.nl/
Thesis seminar guidelines for students:
https://www.student.universiteitleiden.nl/en/your-study-programme/thesis-and-papers/humanities/international-studies-ba?cf=humanities&cd=international-studies-ba#tab-3
Writing Lab:
https://www.student.universiteitleiden.nl/en/vr/humanities/writing-lab?cf=humanities&cd=international-studies-ba
Brightspace page, 'Thesis' folder: Bachelor International Studies, 5_BINTS_OM_2020_9:
https://brightspace.universiteitleiden.nl/d2l/home/16589
Subject Guide 'How to write your thesis':
https://www.library.universiteitleiden.nl/subject-guides/international-studies-how-to-write-your-thesis
POPcorner The Hague:
https://www.student.universiteitleiden.nl/en/vr/general/popcorner-the-hague?cf=humanities&cd=international-studies-ba

Student well-being website:
https://www.student.universiteitleiden.nl/en/vr/general/student-wellbeing?cf=humanities&cd=international-studies-ba
Student psychologists:
https://www.student.universiteitleiden.nl/en/support-and-well-being/health-and-well-being/mental-well-being/humanities/international-studies-ba?cf=humanities&cd=international-studies-ba
Chicago Manual of Style:
http://www.chicagomanualofstyle.org/tools_citationguide.html
Response paper (literature review):
https://twp.duke.edu/sites/twp.duke.edu/files/file-attachments/response-paper.original.pdf
Literature review:
http://writingcenter.unc.edu/handouts/literature-reviews/

Methodology books, among others:

- Uwe Flick, Katie Metzler and Wendy Scott eds., *The SAGE Handbook of Qualitative Data Analysis*, London: Sage, 2014 (online).
- Sandra Halperin and Oliver Heath, *Political Research: Methods and Practical Skills*. Second ed., Oxford [etc.]: Oxford University Press, 2017 (online).
- Michael Stausberg and Steven Engler, *The Routledge Handbook of Research Methods in the study of religion*, London/New York: Routledge, 2011.

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Natasha Mack and Cynthia Woodsong, *Qualitative Research Methods: A Data Collectors Field Guide*, North Carolina: FLI, 2005 (PDF online).